

Editing Video with AI

Plain steps for your first video or your hundredth. I edit in [Descript](#). Most editors now have similar AI tools, so look for the same features in yours.

Ray Villalobos
Senior Staff Instructor
LinkedIn Learning
October 2026

Minutes

For a rough cut that used to take a full day.

41 to 7

Minutes recorded to minutes published on a recent video.

4 clicks

Of AI cleanup on every recording before I read a word.

3x

More videos, same hours. 2 to 3 short videos a week.

Polish it three times

Like a movie, a video gets polished three times. Nothing is set in stone until you publish, so improvise, rewrite and change things along the way.

Write

You write it the way people read. That is a solid first draft.

Record

Say it out loud and you hear what doesn't sound like you. Change it on the spot.

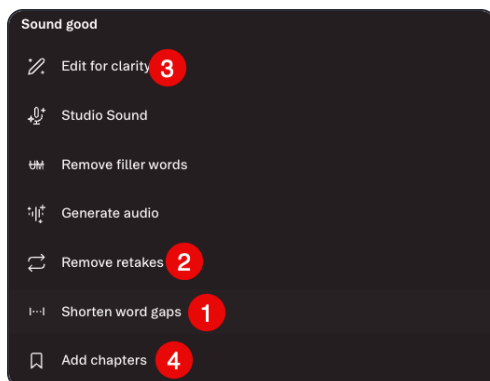
Edit

AI clears the pauses and retakes. You look for ways to make it shorter and tighter.

Publish
Now it's set.

Record like you're editing THE EDIT STARTS AT THE MIC

- Plan what you'll show.** Attention spans are short. Before you hit record, decide what is on screen for each part: a demo, a chart or a screenshot.
- Pause between ideas.** A one second pause gives you a clean spot to cut or to start a new scene.
- Flub a line? Start the sentence over.** Pause, then say the whole sentence again. AI cleanup spots full restarts easily. Fixes in the middle of a sentence are harder for it to catch.
- Record your screen and camera together.** The demo shows the proof. Your face keeps it personal.
- Record more than you need.** My recordings run five to six times longer than the final video. That is normal.
- Save the intro and outro for last.** Once you know what the video says, they are easy. Re-recorded bits like these are called pickups.



Descript's AI tools, numbered in the order I use them.

Let AI do the first cleanup ONE CLICK EACH

Descript turns your video into a transcript. Delete a word and the video cuts with it. These four tools do the first round of cleanup. Run them before you read anything.

- Shorten word gaps.** Trims long pauses. I trim anything over 1 second.
- Remove retakes.** Finds where you started a sentence over and removes the extra take.
- Edit for clarity.** Trims rambling and repeats. I use the medium setting.
- Add chapters.** Labels each section so you can jump around fast.

Also worth a click: Studio Sound makes a home microphone sound like a studio. Remove filler words cuts the ums and uhs.

Using another editor? Look for the same tools: silence removal, retake detection, an AI cleanup pass and automatic chapters.

Make it shorter YOUR JOB IN THE EDIT

AI cleanup clears the pauses and retakes. Your job is to make the video tighter. Read the transcript and look for these.

- 1 **Long setup.** Get to the good part faster. If the demo starts two minutes in, start it sooner.
- 2 **Explaining what's on screen.** People can see what you click. Keep the why and cut the play-by-play.
- 3 **The same idea twice.** You said it again later in different words. Keep the stronger one.
- 4 **Side trips.** A detour that doesn't serve the one point. Cut it or save it for another video.
- 5 **Extra words.** "In this video," "let me show you," "sorry, hold on." Cut them and keep the sentence.
- 6 **A quiet screen.** Twenty seconds with nothing new to see. Trim it, add a visual or re-record it shorter.

Ask the AI editor for a to-do list UNDERLORD, DESCRIPT'S AI EDITOR

Ask for a report first. Pick what you want. Then let it cut. Claude or ChatGPT can fill in these prompts with your details.

STEP 1. ASK FOR A REPORT

Don't edit anything yet. Read my transcript and watch the screen recording. List the time and the exact words for anything I said twice, sentences that start mid-thought, phrases like "in this video," names or web addresses spelled wrong in the captions, spots I should re-record, and lines I could say in fewer words. My recording is correct even where it differs from my script.

STEP 2. APPROVE THE CUTS

Delete only the items below, word for word. Don't reword anything, add anything or create new audio. When you finish, list what changed and tell me if anything else was removed.

1. Delete: "[exact words]"
2. Delete: "[exact words]"

Keep these jobs for yourself

Tiny cuts.

Ask an AI to cut one or two words and it may take the whole phrase. Do those by hand.

Your voice.

Fix caption typos by editing the text.
Don't generate new audio to fix a word.

The final check.

Read the transcript after every AI edit. A fix counts once you see it.

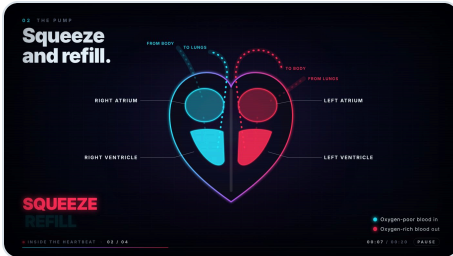
Make it look finished SMALL TOUCHES THAT ADD UP

- 1 **Smart transitions.** Descript adds a smooth move between scenes for you. Set them once in your layouts and every new scene gets them.
- 2 **Layouts.** Build a few once: a title card, a name plate, screen with camera, and a web address bar. Reuse them on every video. On a layout with a web address, turn off Smart Fill so it keeps your exact address.
- 3 **Zoom in on what matters.** When you highlight something on screen, zoom in while you talk about it, then zoom back out. The AI editor can add zooms and callouts for you.
- 4 **Show the web address.** The first time a website appears, put its address on screen so people can find it.
- 5 **Start new scenes with a slash.** Type / in the script to start a new scene. Give each pickup its own scene so the new take drops right in.
- 6 **Add captions.** Descript can highlight each word as you say it. Fix any misspelled names in the text before you export.

Before you export QUICK CHECKLIST

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ Names and web addresses in the captions are spelled right. | ☐ Chapter titles match what you say in each section. | ☐ The video ends on a clear closing line. |
| ☐ No 20 second stretch goes by with nothing new on screen. | ☐ Your re-recorded intro and outro are in place. | ☐ Captions checked again after pickups. New takes bring new typos. |

Visuals you can make in minutes GIVE EVERY PART SOMETHING TO SEE



MOTION GRAPHIC

Animated explainers from a prompt

Claude built this 20 second animated explainer from one short prompt. [Watch it here](#). Play it full screen, record it and drop it in.

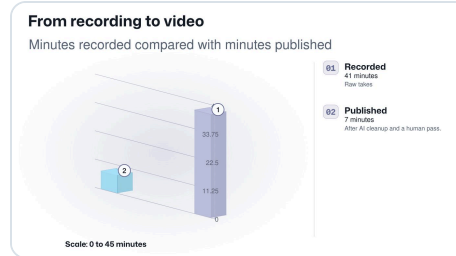


CHART OVERLAY

Charts that sit on your video

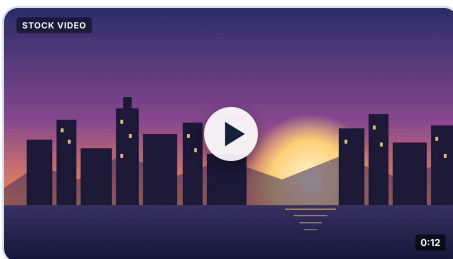
Export a chart as a video with a see-through background. It plays right on top of your recording.



INFOGRAPHIC

One paragraph in, one graphic out

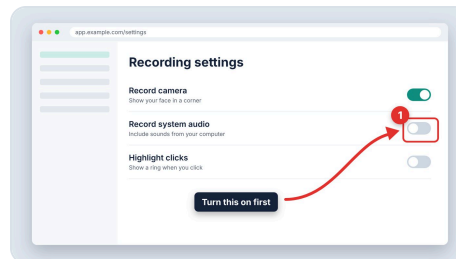
Describe the idea and let an image tool draw it. **PixTaffy** makes graphics like this, and **ChatGPT** has one of the best image generators out there.



STOCK VIDEO

B-roll without a camera

Descript has stock video built in. Search, drag it in, and use it to open a section or cover a voice-over.



SCREENSHOT WITH CALLOUTS

Point at exactly what matters

Snagit grabs quick screenshots and short screen clips. Add numbers, arrows and highlights, then paste them into Descript.

Tools on this page

- **Descript** for editing, AI cleanup, stock video and vertical clips
- **Claude** for motion graphics and writing your AI prompts
- **ChatGPT** for generated images
- **PixTaffy** for infographics in your brand style
- **Snagit** for screenshots, callouts and quick clips

TRY IT: A MOTION GRAPHIC PROMPT FOR CLAUDE

Create a 20 second motion graphic that explains [your idea] in four short scenes: a bold title, the problem, how it works, and one key number. Dark background, bright accent colors, kinetic type. SVG and CSS only, in a single HTML file that plays and loops on its own.

One recording, many videos REUSE EVERYTHING

Go vertical.

Descript reformats a horizontal video into a vertical one for phones.

Cut short clips.

The AI editor finds your strongest moments and trims them to a length you pick. Each clip makes one point.

Post with it.

A companion post reflects what's in the video, teases what people will see, and gives one useful takeaway on its own. Then link to the video. Start from this [post format](#).

Save the final transcript.

Keep it next to your script. Comparing the two shows how you really talk, so your next script sounds more like you.

Your editing workflow START TO FINISH

- Plan** what you'll show
- Record** with pauses and full restarts
- Run AI cleanup** in order
- Make it shorter** by reading the transcript
- Get the AI report**, then approve cuts
- Record pickups** for the intro, outro and fixes
- Polish** with layouts, zooms and visuals
- Run the checklist**
- Export** long, vertical and clips